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Rose

André stood outside the cinema, hair slicked back, brown jacket over white shirt, shoulders hunched forward, eyes pinned to the ground. Rose sensed a sharp air of vigilance about him but the moment their eyes met, his demeanor softened and he approached her, hands at his sides.

“You look lovely,” he said, grinning.

She wore her hair loose, a pin on the side holding it off her face. “Thanks.” She’d wanted to look nice and was glad she’d worn the lucky blue dress her mother made for Léa’s interviews, paired with a white cardigan for warmth. She pointed to the poster. “Are we watching *Remorques*?”

He nodded, unable to look away from her. She felt off-kilter, used to being the observer, not the observed.

“What do you think?” he asked.

“Wonderful, it’s only my second time at the movies.” Her first movie had been when Léa received two free tickets from Maître Mallon. “Will we be able to get in?”

“Wait here.” He bounded over to the ticket counter. She looked at the poster. The illustrator had drawn Jean Gabin, Madeleine Renaud and Michèle Morgan against a backdrop of a boat battling rough waves in the sea. She noticed their eyes matched the blue of the water. She thought the artist had done a good job.

André returned. “It shouldn’t be a problem. Let’s wait across the street.”

They moved away from the people gathered in a line, crossed the street and stood in front of a cobbler’s shop.

“Thank you for Saturday,” she said. “Léa had a wonderful time.”